

Cover Letter – Dev Infra Lead at Airbnb

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Airbnb

Dear Hiring Manager,

I am excited to apply for the Dev Infra Lead position at Airbnb. Your mission to enable developers to deliver high-quality code quickly and reliably resonates deeply with me. I am inspired by the opportunity to drive technical strategy, build robust developer infrastructure, and help shape the future of Airbnb's engineering productivity.

Why I'm Excited About Airbnb

Airbnb's commitment to building cloud-based developer environments, blazing-fast build systems, and a polyglot monorepo aligns perfectly with my passion for developer productivity and infrastructure excellence. The chance to partner with engineers across the Infra org, AI/ML, and Developer Platform teams to reduce friction and scale workflows is especially motivating.

Relevant Experience & Impact

Developer Infrastructure & Monorepo Expertise - Over 20 years of experience building and operating high-scale, distributed systems and developer infrastructure for enterprise and SMB clients (Barclays, McKinsey, Biophy, Yotascale, Boomi, etc.) - Deep hands-on expertise with Python, Bazel, and monorepo strategies, including optimizing build performance and scaling developer workflows - Experience building secure, efficient, and highly available frameworks and platforms that abstract away infrastructure complexity

Technical Leadership & Collaboration - Led and shipped large-scope technical projects in collaboration with multiple experienced engineers - Served as a player/coach, ensuring code quality, operational excellence, and commitment to craft - Partnered with engineering leaders and teams to drive adoption of new capabilities and deliver measurable improvements in developer experience and velocity

Full-Cycle Development & Problem Solving - Strong ownership and experience building and operating distributed systems across the full software lifecycle - Familiarity with container and orchestration technologies such as Docker and Kubernetes - Excellent communication skills and ability to work well

within and across engineering teams - Passionate about developer productivity, problem solving, and making developer lives better

Why I'm a Strong Fit for Airbnb

My experience in developer infrastructure, Python, Bazel, and monorepo environments, combined with my technical leadership and passion for developer productivity, positions me to make a significant impact at Airbnb. I thrive in collaborative, high-scale environments and am eager to help Airbnb build the foundation for its next decade of technical growth.

Thank you for considering my application. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss how my background and vision align with Airbnb's mission and how I can contribute to your continued success.

Sincerely,

Yongjun Rong